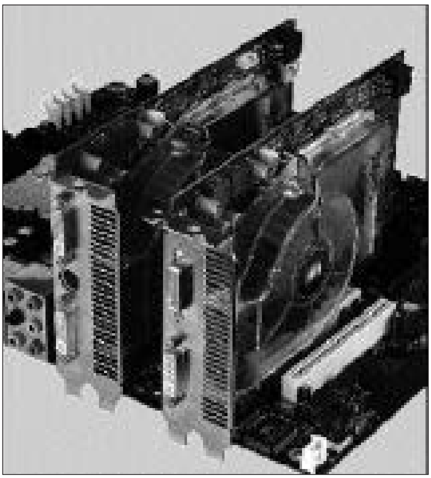
the data is to be sent to a CRT monitor, the ROP sends the data to the RAMDAC.

4.2.26 SBA

Side Band Addressing refers to use of the additional channels incorporated by the AGP bus. Besides the 32-bit bus, the AGP specifications created an additional 8-bit address bus, called the Side Band, for transfer of data requests. Using this channel, the 32-bit bus could be freed, thus improving data transfers.

4.2.27 SLI / CrossFire

Scalable Link Interface is a mechanism that allows the performance of two or more graphics cards plugged into PCI Express slots to be combined. It was created by graphics card manufacturer NVIDIA to work with NVIDIA graphics cards only. CrossFire is a similar technology launched by ATI (later taken over by AMD) that works only with their graphics cards. For SLI / CrossFire to work, the graphics cards must be of the same type, and the motherboard should support the technology, besides having two PCIE X16 slots. The graphics cards are connected via a special cable called a Bridge Connector (though CrossFire models connect through the PCIE bus or one of the cards should be a CrossFire edition card). In SLI mode, one of the cards acts as a master, and the output is available only through it. The graphics load is distributed in two ways. In Split Frame Rendering, the display area is divided into two halves horizontally, with each card responsible for one half; in Alternate Frame Rendering, each card renders every alternate frame.



A CrossFire setup